

Pooja Singh

WOMEN'S
HIGH JUMP

Pooja Singh demands serious gold consideration. The 19-year-old talent became senior Asian champion with 1.89m in 2025, took Asian Indoor silver at 1.87m in February and raised the Indian record to 1.93m while winning the Asian Under-20 title in May. That record gives her the highest current clearance among the confirmed Chinese and Japanese entrants. China has selected Lu Jiawen and Jin Ruoxuan, while Japan will field Nagisa Takahashi and Yuzuki Ishioka. The established opposition includes defending Asian Games champion Safina Sadullayeva and current Asian record-holder Nadezhda Dubovitskaya. Singh's concern is recent international consistency: she won the National Inter-State title at 1.83m, finished eighth at the Commonwealth Games with 1.77m and placed seventh at the World Under-20 Championships. Her ceiling is nevertheless championship-winning. If she clears 1.88m cleanly and approaches her record, India has a credible route to Asian Games gold.

RITURAJ KONWAR

